

# Saying times and making appointments

## Learner workbook

Agree on an unambiguous time.

## Understand the distinction

You can say 9:15 as nine fifteen or a quarter past nine. 9:45 can be nine forty-five or a quarter to ten. Digital forms are often easiest when confirming an appointment.

Use a.m. or p.m. when the part of the day is unclear. Noon is midday; midnight is the start of a new day in date-based schedules. Include the date and time zone for an international meeting. Confirm rather than guess.

## Compare the patterns

### PAST THE HOUR

a quarter past nine

9:15

### BEFORE THE HOUR

a quarter to ten

9:45

### CONFIRM

Is that 9 a.m. Tokyo time?

Clarify the time zone and part of day.

Read each example and notice how its form changes the meaning. Use these distinctions to choose your answers on the following pages.

## Check your understanding

Circle one answer for each question. There is one correct choice among the options shown. Check the answer key after choosing.

1. Which time is half past two?

A. 2:30

B. 2:15

C. 1:30

2. Which time is a quarter to six?

A. 5:45

B. 6:45

C. 6:15

3. What should you clarify in Let's meet at eight if you are in different countries?

A. The date, a.m. or p.m., and time zone.

B. Only whether eight is written as a digit or a word.

C. Only the length of the meeting.

## Choose the best response

Choose the response that fits the situation. Check both its meaning and its grammar.

4. Which message gives an exact appointment date and time and asks about the time zone?

- A. Let's meet soon. Is that London time?
- B. Let's meet on 12 September at 10 a.m. Is that London time?
- C. Let's meet on 12 September at ten. I will see you then.

### Review your choices

Use the answer explanations on the next page. If you chose a different answer, find the detail that makes it unsuitable and try the question again.

### Practice online

The web lesson gives feedback for the option you select and lets you try again. No written response is required.

## Answers and explanation

### 1. A. 2:30

Half past means thirty minutes after the hour.

### 2. A. 5:45

It is fifteen minutes before six.

### 3. A. The date, a.m. or p.m., and time zone.

A complete appointment avoids assumptions.

### 4. B. Let's meet on 12 September at 10 a.m. Is that London time?

It includes the date, clock time, a.m., and a time-zone check.

### Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: [englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-31.html](https://englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-31.html)